

ESSENTIAL

Document Checklist by Funding Type

Self/Family-Funded - Scholarship - Assistantship - Dependents - Reapplication

Every applicant needs

- Valid passport meeting the validity requirement
- Signed Form I-20 from your SEVP-approved school
- SEVIS I-901 fee payment receipt
- Completed DS-160 confirmation page and visa fee (MRV fee) receipt
- Academic documents used for your admission
- Financial evidence matching your I-20's stated cost figure

If you're self-funded or family-funded

- Personal or family bank statements covering a reasonable recent period
- If a family member is funding you: their financial evidence and a funding letter

If you're funded by a scholarship

- A scholarship confirmation letter stating the amount and duration covered
- Your own financial evidence for any remaining amount not covered

If you're a graduate student with an assistantship

TA/RA OFFER LETTERS COUNT AS FUNDING EVIDENCE

A teaching or research assistantship offer letter from your department, stating your stipend and any tuition waiver, is genuinely strong evidence for graduate F-1 applicants - it directly supports both your funding case and your academic fit for the program. See the Sponsor & Funding Letter Templates (Complete tier).

If you're bringing F-2 dependents

- Marriage/birth certificates establishing the relationship
- Additional financial evidence covering your school's stated per-dependent cost, on top of your own

If you're reapplying after a previous refusal

- A clear, specific update addressing the exact reason given for your previous refusal
- Updated financial evidence and, if applicable, a deferred I-20 start date from your DSO